

Bài tập thực hành 2

The nature of success

We live in a world where success is highly valued in all fields of endeavour. However, is it really possible to compare success in business or sports with success in the academic world of studies? Success at school comes from a certain amount of application and certainly is not given to everyone, although nobody actually aims to do badly in exams. But what does it lead to? The correlation between good exam results as a teenager and a good degree and success beyond one's studies is hard to measure. This is perhaps because school and university are seen as steps towards something further and not a goal in their own right. Success in exams, you might say, is like winning part of a race, but not the race itself. Despite the high expectations that they might have had, the reality is that millions of graduates across the world are in jobs that do not stretch them, or are not particularly well-rewarded; many recent graduates are unable to even find a job of any sort in these times of economic uncertainty. In other words, academic success seems to be an unreliable indicator of actual potential.

Sporting success brings local, national or international acclaim, and, in the case of the most popular professional sports, financial rewards that are beyond the reach of most of us. What do most successful sports men and women have in common? Natural ability and a great deal of training, for sure. Many will have decided to turn their backs on the parties and socializing of their peers in order to do more lengths in the pool or more hours in the gym, to work on their sprint or serving or cycling or passing techniques. Another sad fact of sporting life is that careers are short and often plagued by injury.

In business, success is generally measured by salary rather than specific achievements, records or popularity. When asked, most people who have fulfilled their ambitions in business will attribute their success to putting in long hours in the early stages of their career, and determination. In addition, however, they will almost always mention something that is all too often overlooked by those for whom business is simply a way of paying the bills, and that's innovation. Business success does not come to those who simply do their jobs or follow their leaders. It is creative.

Read the following passage and answer the questions.

Đọc toàn bộ đoạn văn sau và chọn Yes hoặc No cho mỗi statement dưới đây

- Yes - Statement đồng tình với quan điểm của tác giả
- No - Statement trái ngược với quan điểm của tác giả
- NOT GIVEN - Không thể biết được quan điểm của tác giả là gì

According to the writer ...

anyone can be successful at school if they set the right targets.

- ☐ A. Yes
- ☐ B. No

☐ C. Not given

all forms of success depend on hard work.

- ☐ A. Yes
☐ B. No
☐ C. Not given

everyone has some sort of ambition.

- ☐ A. Yes
☐ B. No
☐ C. Not given

success in sport often depends on making sacrifices.

- ☐ A. Yes
☐ B. No
☐ C. Not given

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the financial rewards compensate for the fact that sporting careers are short.

- ☐ A. Yes
☐ B. No
☐ C. Not given

many people fail to understand one of the key elements of business success.

- ☐ A. Yes
☐ B. No
☐ C. Not given